

Northbean Brand Book

Premium small-batch cold brew for people who take their mornings seriously.

1. The Brand

Who we are

Northbean is a direct-to-consumer cold brew company founded in 2021 in Portland, Oregon. We work with single-origin beans from small farms in Ethiopia, Colombia, and Guatemala, slow-steep them for 18 hours in filtered water, and ship bottles within 72 hours of brewing.

We're not the cheapest cold brew. We're the one you save for the morning you actually want to enjoy.

Mission

Make exceptional cold brew accessible to people who care about quality but don't have time to make it themselves.

Vision

A world where the default morning coffee isn't a compromise.

2. Audience

Primary persona — "The Considered Consumer"

- Age 28–42
- Urban or near-urban, \$80K+ household income
- Already buys premium grocery (Whole Foods, farmers markets, specialty olive oil)
- Cooks 3+ nights a week
- Reads ingredient labels
- Treats coffee as a daily ritual, not just caffeine delivery

Secondary persona — "The Upgrader"

- Age 24–35
 - Used to drink Starbucks daily, now wants better
 - Discovered specialty coffee in the last 2 years
 - Active on social media, follows food and lifestyle accounts
 - Buys based on aesthetic and taste together
-

3. Voice and Tone

Voice Attributes

Our voice is:

- **Confident, not arrogant.** We know our product is good. We don't need to shout about it.
- **Warm, not casual.** Friendly without being chummy.
- **Specific, not vague.** We name origins, processes, and tasting notes. We don't say "premium beans" — we say "single-origin Ethiopian Yirgacheffe."
- **Curious, not preachy.** We talk about coffee like a craft, not a religion.

Things we say

- "Slow-steeped for 18 hours."
- "Single-origin Ethiopian Yirgacheffe with notes of bergamot and dark chocolate."
- "Brewed Tuesday, on your doorstep Friday."
- "The best coffee shop is the one in your kitchen."
- "Ritual, not routine."

Things we don't say

- "World's best coffee" (vague, unverifiable)
- "Game-changer" (overused, lazy)
- "Wake up and seize the day!" (cheesy, not us)
- "Coffee that hits different" (slang we don't use)
- "Your daily fuel" (transactional, we're about ritual)

Banned words

disrupt, revolutionary, game-changer, fuel, hits different, slay, vibe, lit, mind-blowing, life-changing, insane, crazy good

4. Color System

Primary palette

- **Deep Espresso** — **#2B1810** — Used for primary text, headers, and dark backgrounds
- **Warm Cream** — **#F5EFE0** — Used for primary backgrounds and surface fills
- **Copper Accent** — **#B8714D** — Used for CTAs, brand moments, and accent elements

Secondary palette

- **Steam White** — **#FFFFFF** — Used for product photography backgrounds
- **Steeped Black** — **#0F0A07** — Used for high-contrast moments only

Color rules

- Never pair Copper Accent with Steeped Black (creates muddy contrast)
 - Always lead with Cream + Espresso for body content
 - Use Copper for emphasis, never for body text
 - Maintain WCAG AA contrast minimum on all text
-

5. Typography

Heading typeface

Söhne Breit (or fallback: **Inter** at heavy weight)

- Used for all H1, H2, H3 elements
- Weight: 600 for H1, 500 for H2/H3
- Tracking: -0.02em on H1, -0.01em on H2

Body typeface

Söhne (or fallback: **Inter**)

- Used for all body copy, captions, UI
- Weight: 400 regular, 500 for emphasis
- Line height: 1.6 minimum

Display typeface

Editorial New (used sparingly, editorial moments only)

- Used for hero pull-quotes and brand storytelling
 - Weight: 400 regular only
 - Italic for emphasis
-

6. Logo Rules

Clear space

The Northbean wordmark requires minimum clear space equal to the cap-height of the "N" on all sides. Never crowd.

Backgrounds

- Logo on Cream → Espresso wordmark
- Logo on Espresso → Cream wordmark
- Logo on photography → Cream wordmark with 80% opacity backdrop

Don'ts

- Never stretch, skew, or rotate the wordmark
 - Never apply effects (drop shadows, glows, outlines)
 - Never reproduce smaller than 80px wide
 - Never use Copper Accent on the wordmark itself
-

7. Brand do's and don'ts

Do

- Lead with the product, not the lifestyle
- Show the bottle, the brew, the bean
- Use natural light photography
- Quote our farmers when relevant
- Reference brewing time, temperature, and process
- Use sentence case for headlines
- Write at a 9th-grade reading level

Don't

- Use stock photography of generic coffee shops
 - Show people drinking coffee while running, working out, or being "busy"
 - Imply caffeine dependence or hustle culture
 - Use Title Case Headlines Like This
 - Use exclamation points (we're confident, not excited)
 - Reference "morning routines" generically — we have a specific point of view
-

8. Channel Considerations

Meta (Facebook + Instagram)

- 1:1 and 4:5 aspect ratios primary
- First 3 seconds must show product or brewing process
- Caption-first storytelling — assume sound off
- Cream and Espresso lead, Copper for CTA only

TikTok / Reels

- 9:16 vertical
- Native-feeling content (handheld, real, unpolished)
- 15–30 second videos
- Show the brewing or pour, not the lifestyle
- On-screen captions with our typography

Google Display

- 1200x628 (1.91:1) standard
- Headline + product shot + CTA, no clutter
- Cream background with Espresso headline, Copper CTA

YouTube Shorts

- 9:16 vertical
 - 30–60 seconds
 - Process-driven storytelling
 - Voiceover-led, music secondary
-

9. Approval

All brand decisions ultimately route to the founder, Maya. When in doubt: lead with the product, write less, and let the coffee speak.